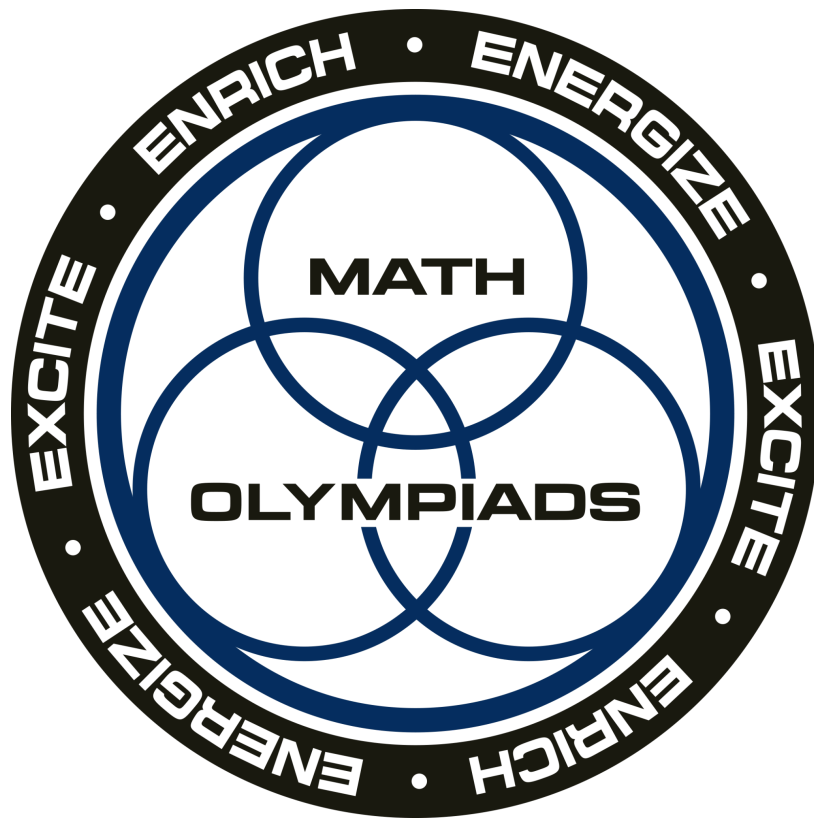


MOEMS[®] PICO HANDBOOK



APPENDIX G - PICO HANDBOOK, Organization & Procedures

PICO (PRONOUNCED PEE-KO)

This is the acronym we use for the team coach and contact person. It stands for the Person In Charge of the Olympiad. The name and the email address of the PICO must be included on the registration form and all correspondence with MOEMS®.

TEAM COMPOSITION

School Teams: All students come from one school only.

Home School Teams: Students attend a Home-School Association affiliated with a single school district.

District Teams: Students may come from different schools within the same district. Teams that are composed of students from several schools in the same district, or Gifted and Talented Programs from the same district fall into this category. Approval by our office is required. Call 516.781.2400 for authorization.

Institute Team: Olympiad Contests and practice sessions are run by a private organization. No student may be on an Institute Team if he/she attends a school that fields a MOEMS® School Team, even if that student is not a member of the School Team. Approval by our office is required. Call 516.781.2400 for authorization.

DIVISIONS

To participate, each student must be enrolled in the member school, institute, or district. Students who have completed eighth grade may not participate. A team with any 7th or 8th grade student must be in Division M. A team with any 4th or 5th grade student should be in Division E, but 4th and 5th graders may be placed on a Division M team if appropriate. 6th grade students may be placed on either a Division E or Division M team. No team may be split between two divisions; however, a school may put any of its 6th grade students on both a Division E and Division M team, if both divisions are available at that school.

TEAM SIZE

The maximum number of students on one team is 35. A school may enroll more than one team, There is no set minimum number of team members. A team's score is determined after the 5th Olympiad, by the cumulative scores of the top 10 students.

ENTERING STUDENT ROSTERS

On the MOEMS® secure website, click on Team Listing>View

Option 1 - Manual Student Entry

Click on New Student

Enter: First Name, Last Name and Grade

Click Save

(Repeat for each student.)

Option 2 - CSV Upload

- Click on Upload Team Member
- Click Download template file here
- Enter student data in CSV file and Save
- Click Choose File (link the saved student data file)
- Click Upload
- (Repeat for each team.)

START UP MATERIALS

The following documents are available at the MOEMS® secure website after the PICO logs in with a Username and Password:

- Fifty (50) practice problems with detailed solutions from the previous two years. These are included to help students and new PICOs understand what to expect on the upcoming contests.
- The Online Scoring System, where students' name and grade are entered by the PICO before any student scores may be entered.
- The **Organization and Procedures** (this document), which is our rulebook. Printing out a copy for easy access is suggested.
- **What Every Mathlete Should Know**, which lists and defines terms that could be used in our Olympiad Contests.
- **Message to Parents**, which helps build parental support. It is suggested that the PICO reproduce enough copies to send home with each student.

DATES, TIME AND PLACE

Five Olympiads, each consisting of five questions, and limited to **30 minutes** are held monthly from November through March. MOEMS® sets the contest administration window for each Olympiad, and asks that it is followed.

There are **no make-ups or early administration** for any reason for students who cannot be present on the announced date.

All contests should be given within the administration window, and under no circumstances, earlier than the first day of the administration window.

In Person

- All students must take the contest at the same time, in the same location on the same day.

OnLine

- All students must take the contest at the same time on the same day.

PREPARATION

Approximately one week before the announced date of each Olympiad Contest, an email is sent to the PICO advising that the Olympiad is available for download. The PICO should then do the following:

- **Pages 1–2 (*Olympiad Problems and Student Answer Sheet*):** Print out enough copies for all participants. This should be done as two single sided pages to allow the students the blank sides to be used as scrap paper.
- **Pages 3–4 (*Answers and Solutions*):** Print out one copy for the PICO for scoring an Olympiad.
- **Disposition:** Place all materials in a secure location until the day of the contest. Open it only at the contest in the presence of the student participants to assure your students of the security of the MOEMS® events.
- Following the contest, the PICO may wish to distribute copies of the questions to other teachers for classroom use only. This can build support for the program among your colleagues.
- The PICO may also wish to distribute copies of the solutions along with a *copy* of their actual contest to all team members after the Olympiad. By doing so, students will have materials from which to study, and parents may see what their children were asked to do. Papers may be distributed **ONLY AFTER THE ADMINISTRATION WINDOW HAS CLOSED.**
- **IMPORTANT! These are copyrighted materials. Under no circumstances, may the actual contests or individual problems and/or solutions be published in any form, including on the internet or “secure” websites.**

IF ENGLISH IS NOT THE FIRST LANGUAGE

With the increase of mathletes for whom English is not their first language, the following procedures become more important.

- The PICO is authorized to create a written foreign language version of each contest for any non-English reader. This translation should be attached to the original contest for storage. No additional time may be allocated for students using this accommodation.
- Students are able to use an English to foreign “word-to-word” dictionary, or an electronic version of that dictionary. No additional time may be allocated for students using this accommodation.

MATERIALS PERMITTED FOR CONTEST

The contest paper and scrap paper should be given to students. No other materials or tools are permitted. These include, but are not limited to, graph paper, rulers, protractors, calculators, or other electronic devices, including telephones.

STUDENTS WITH IEPs

All IEP accommodations should be followed.

ADMINISTRATION & PROCTORING CONTESTS

A proctor (usually, the PICO) must actively observe and monitor the students at all times. No one may help any student in any way during the contest. After distributing the Olympiad face down and once the proctor is sure all pens/pencils are down, students should be instructed to turn over their papers and follow along as the proctor reads aloud all five questions. Once the questions have been read, the proctor should give the students the signal to begin, reminding them that they have exactly 30 minutes to complete the contest. Students must receive all five questions as a single set, and be given 30 minutes to complete all five questions, budgeting their time as they see fit.

The only student questions that may be answered during the contest are those concerning words that need clarification, and in these cases alternate words may be given but not definitions or explanations. For example, if a question used the term “ones digit”, a PICO is allowed to state that “units digit” is the same as “ones digit”, but not allowed to say that “the units digit is the first digit to the left of the decimal point.”

The PICO must give 15-, 10-, and 5-minute warnings to the students. For OnLine teams student answers must be entered properly in the provided answer spaces and submitted before the contest closes down. NOTE: The OnLine contest can be submitted early by the student but will be closed by the PICO once time has elapsed. Once submitted, the contest may not be revisited by the student.

SCORING AN OLYMPIAD

Consider all scores confidential. After all the papers have been collected, use the Answers and Solutions sheet to check student answers. Student answers must match our key exactly to be credited. If a student feels another answer should be given credit, there is an appeals process in place (See “Appeals” later in this document). At the bottom of the students’ answer boxes is a box to record the number of correct answers he/she scored for that contest.

REPORTING SCORES

On the MOEMS® secure website, click on My Results/Statistics
Click on the correct Division (E or M)
Click on the Olympiad for which you wish to enter results
Click Enter Results (be sure you have the correct team)
Click Edit
Enter student scores
Click Save
(Repeat the steps for each team/Olympiad)

- **Correct Answer:** Click the appropriate box under the problems answered correctly by the student.
- **Incorrect Answer:** Leave the appropriate boxes blank.

- ***Did Not Participate:*** click the ABSENT box. Also, click this box for any students no longer on your team. Note: clicking ABSENT will override all other checkmarks for that student on that Olympiad.

Corrections to scoring may be made online at any time up until March 31. Printing out a copy of the scores for each Olympiad is recommended.

Important – The final results for all contests must be entered online by March 31. The Online Scoring System will close on that date. There are NO exceptions.

RECORD KEEPING

It is strongly suggested that PICOs ***keep all original answer sheets until all awards have been received.*** After the contest administration window, you may return the answer sheets and the questions to your students. Having the original answer sheets serves several purposes. It allows regrading after an appeal a much simpler process than trying to get the students to return their results. It facilitates score corrections (if necessary) after all your results have been finalized on the website. And finally, in the rare, unfortunate situation of a student changing an answer after a contest has been returned, verification is close at hand.

APPEALS & THE APPEALS PROCESS

Appeals may be granted only for alternate acceptable answers utilizing valid interpretations based on compliance with What Every Mathlete Should Know. Appeals are not granted for a reading or a copying error by the student, or if any condition of the problem is ignored. Only a PICO may make a formal request for an appeal.

Here is how an appeal works...

- (1) We receive one or more requests for an appeal to a specific question and its answer;
- (2) We generate an email to our Appeals Committee (11 – 13 members, depending upon the Division), and ask that each member submits an “approval” or “denial” of the appeal, normally within 48 hours;
- (3) ***If the appeal is approved:*** As soon as a majority of those members “approve” the appeal request, an e-mail will be sent to all PICOs of that division;
- (4) When approved, PICOs will be instructed to give credit for the newly accepted answer, as well as for the original answer (unless it was mathematically incorrect), and to correct the records submitted on our secure website;
- (5) ***If the appeal is denied:*** Only those PICOs who raised the appeal will be notified.

As a PICO, you should keep a copy of the original students answers, so that the correction of grades may be facilitated. It is best to keep the answer sheets for the entire year in a secure place. Given this procedure, please understand that the entire process can take up to 5 or 6 business days after the first appeal is received. We take our mission to provide creative and intellectually-stimulating problem solving experiences very seriously, and will continue to hear your concerns.

AWARDS

All end-of-year awards are determined from the online scores entered by our PICOs. Awards are shipped approximately 30-45 days after the conclusion of Olympiad 5. We will make every attempt to get your awards to you before the end of your academic year. Only School Teams and Home-School Teams are considered for Team Awards; District Teams and Institute teams are not permitted to compete for Team Awards due to the team composition.

Individual Awards

- A Certificate of Participation for each student who took part in MOEMS
- An embroidered Olympiad Iron-On Patch for each student whose cumulative score ranks in the top 50 % of their division
- A “Gold Pin” or a “Silver Pin” for each student whose cumulative score is in the top 2% or 3-10% of their division, respectively
- **One** Olympiad medal for the highest individual scorer for each team. ***In the event of a tie, additional medals may be purchased by the PICO***
- A boxed Medallion (the George Lenchner Award) for any student scoring a perfect 25 on his/her cumulative score
- ***Note: “Honorable Mention” medals are available for purchase for students who the PICO might want to acknowledge.***

Team Awards

A Team’s Score is computed by taking the sum of the ten highest scores on each team.

- For Each Division: A plaque for “Highest Team Achievement” for a team score in the top 10% of all participating teams
- For Each Division: A “High Achievement” Certificate for a team score in the next 10% (11% – 20%) of all participating teams
- For Division E: A “Grade 4 Meritorious Certificate” for each of the top 20% of teams with no grade 5 or 6 student
- For Division E: A “Grade 5 Meritorious Certificate” for each of the top 20% of teams with no grade 6 student
- For Division M: A “Grade 6 Meritorious Certificate” for each of the top 20% of teams with no grade 7 or 8 student
- For Division E: A “Grade 7 Meritorious Certificate” for each of the top 20% of teams with no grade 8 student

HONOR ROLL

MOEMS® publishes an Honor Roll to commemorate the top scoring teams and students. The honor roll can be viewed and printed from the MOEMS® secure website or can be purchased in a stapled booklet format. The honor roll contains a section for each of the team awards listed above as well as sections for students scoring 25 or 24 points.

- HIGHEST TEAM ACHIEVEMENT (for each division the top 10% of all participating teams)
- HIGH TEAM ACHIEVEMENT (for each division the 11-20% of all participating teams)
- MERITORIOUS ACHIEVEMENT (for each division the top 20% of all participating teams whose members were in the lower grades for their division)
- STUDENTS WITH A PERFECT SCORE (for each division)
- STUDENTS WITH ONE LESS THAN A PERFECT SCORE (for each division)